

ABOUBACAR SAKHO

SOC Analyst | Security Operations & Incident Response

Houston, TX | 346-917-7951 | aoubacar.sakho@email.com | LinkedIn | GitHub

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

SOC Analyst with hands-on experience in incident response, threat hunting, and detection engineering gained through a six-month Cyber Range internship. Investigated 100+ security incidents using Microsoft Sentinel, Defender XDR/EDR, Sysmon, Windows Event Logs, Zeek, and Wireshark. Authored 1,000+ KQL/SPL detection queries and Sigma rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK. Skilled in log analysis, network security monitoring (NSM), vulnerability management, and the NIST 800-61 incident response lifecycle. Proficient in Windows, Linux, PowerShell, Python, and Bash.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

SIEM & SOC Operations: Microsoft Sentinel, Splunk Enterprise, KQL, SPL, Sigma Rules, Alert & Detection Engineering, SOAR, Log Analysis, Threat Intelligence, Threat Hunting

Endpoint & Network Security: Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (EDR/XDR), Sysmon, Windows Event Logs, Wireshark, Zeek, Network Security Monitoring (NSM), IDS/IPS, Firewalls, Static/Dynamic Malware Analysis

Frameworks & Risk: MITRE ATT&CK, Cyber Kill Chain, NIST 800-61, Incident Response, Vulnerability Management, Risk Assessment, Active Directory

Scripting & Systems: PowerShell, Python, Bash, Windows Server, Linux, Cloud Security (Azure)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

SOC Analyst Intern / Cyber Range Engineer

Dec 2025 – Jun 2026

LogNPacific Cyber Range

- Investigated 100+ security incidents involving malware, credential abuse, persistence, lateral movement, and command-and-control (C2) activity across a simulated enterprise network.
- Conducted proactive threat hunting using KQL and SPL to identify malicious activity beyond alert-based detection.
- Built Microsoft Sentinel analytics rules and Sigma detections mapped to MITRE ATT&CK, improving detection coverage.
- Led incident response for botnet infections across seven virtual machines, tracing C2 callbacks and cryptomining activity to weak Linux credentials; remediated and hardened affected hosts.
- Completed 200+ hours of Cyber Range exercises and built 5+ SOC monitoring dashboards for real-time visibility.

IT Systems Administrator / Owner

2018 – 2024

Sakho Computer & Cellphones, Houston, TX

- Diagnosed and repaired Windows, macOS, and mobile devices; performed malware remediation and OS deployments for hundreds of clients.
- Supported small-business network security, infrastructure troubleshooting, and endpoint hardening.

Independent Network Engineering Study

2003 – 2018

Houston, TX

- Completed extensive hands-on Cisco IOS routing and switching labs in GNS3 while working toward CCIE-level network engineering expertise, building a strong foundation in network architecture, protocols, and infrastructure security.

Computer Laboratory Manager

2001 – 2003

International Network & Business Center, Guinea

- Designed, deployed, and managed a 50-workstation educational computer lab and cyber cafe, overseeing network setup and system administration.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

M.S., Cybersecurity — University of Houston–Downtown (2020)

Graduate Certificate in Cybersecurity — University of Houston–Downtown (2019)

B.S., Economics & Management — International Islamic University Malaysia

Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate | Microsoft Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900) | CISSP (In Progress)

SELECTED ACHIEVEMENTS

100+ Security Investigations | 200+ Cyber Range Hours | 4 AI Security Agents Built | 5+ SOC Dashboards | 1,000+ KQL Queries Authored | Multiple Threat Hunting Competition Awards